

—BOB INGRAM—

For 'Krush,' the figures didn't lie



KRUSHWITZ

WHEN THE U.T. El Paso Miners played Colorado State Saturday night in the Special Events Center, 20 years of statistical work for the school in football and basketball were completed by O.C. Krushwitz.

Having written down enough figures to fill several books, "Krush" decided to hang up his calculator, his slide rule, percentage tables, pencil sharpener and other tools of his trade.

There should have been more than just a simple announcement. He should have been presented a cake with .750 on it instead of candles. That could be Krush's batting average over 20 years. One of .1000 would be better but Krush would be the first to say that nobody's perfect and no baseball player ever hit as much as .750 over a 20-year span.

Krush retired on his own volition. He said in his job as a real estate appraiser with C.W. Lyons and Associates, he's compelled to travel a good deal.

It was a difficult decision to make since Krush has been allied closely with the school for so long a time. He was a mathematics teacher at the school for several years and for seven years helped Andy Cohen coach the Miner baseball team.

Stat man's delight

KRUSHWITZ WAS prepared for the opening game of the 1965 football season at UTEP. It marked the debut of Bobby Dobbs as head coach.

The Miners opened with North Texas in the Sun Bowl. "I knew there would be a lot of action in the game," Krush said. "Prior to it the Miners held an intrasquad scrimmage and there were something like 80 passes thrown."

Bill Stevens threw for a touchdown on the first Miner play from scrimmage, Krush remembers. He and his statistical crew weren't disappointed. They kept busy jotting down all the passes Stevens threw in amassing 500 aerial yards as the Miners won 61-15.

Yvonne in pain but wins match

DALLAS (UPI) — Second-seeded Yvonne Goolagong overcame problems with a recurring instep injury to defeat unseeded Sue Barker, 6-3, 7-6, yesterday in the first round of the Virginia Slims of Dallas tennis tournament.

Eighth-seeded Rosemary Casals of San Francisco also trailed 3-0 early but defeated Bunny Bruning of La Jolla, Calif., 6-3, 7-5.

"Another Miner game sticks out in my memory," said Krush. "That was a game we played against Arizona State in the Sun Bowl and should have won. But Ben Hawkins, one of the ASU backs, broke loose at the last minute and hurdled over several players to get the winning ASU touchdown."

Krush became an early believer of the Miners in basketball in their 1965-66 season capped by them winning the NCAA championship.

"When I saw them play Nevada and win by 86-49, I knew they had something going for them. Willie Worsley and Willie Cager just tore up Nevada. That game put a lot of people on the Miner bandwagon."

Among UTEP basketball players, Nate "Tiny" Archibald was one of Krush's favorites.

And in baseball, he remembers a Miner team that had such players as Larry McFarland, Charlie West, Bobby Aguirre, Jay Christopher, Al Lopez, Bob Berryhill, Mike Huerta and others and calls it one closest to his heart.

Coaching aids

KRUSH KEEPS statistics in their proper perspective. He doesn't think they are the most important aspects of athletics.

He admits they can be deceiving. Some teams wind up with more first downs and more yardage than their opponents yet lose. It has been said that statistics are for losers.

Krush does believe statistics are helpful coaches. They do give any coach a pretty good line on his players and team "tendency" which seems to be a big thing in scouting.

The knottiest problem Krush has had in his career as a statistician came in the Arizona-Auburn Sun Bowl game in 1962.

Arizona had two fourth down punts. One of the punts was blocked. The ball bounded back to the Arizona punter. He got it away this time for about 15 or 20 yards. Krush's decision was to credit Arizona with two punts. One was a team punt and the other was given to the player who kicked the ball twice.

"You've got to be objective to be a good statistician," said Krush. "You should be fair to all the athletes."

In other words, don't be a "homer."

Stats, Krush admits, haven't changed with the times in this country. There is no inflation in those figures statisticians put down. If a team back in 1960 made 16 out of 21 free throws, its percentage was .762. A team hitting 16 of 21 today also gets .762.